DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 11

Affiliate marketer (including Shopify affiliate programmes)

Profession 11 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

An affiliate marketer earns a commission by promoting other businesses' products or services through a tracked link. On e-commerce platforms such as Shopify, merchants run affiliate programmes that pay partners for sales they bring.

What professionals do every day

Chooses products or programmes, creates honest content, places tracked links, tracks clicks and sales, follows the programme's rules and discloses the affiliate relationship.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Merchants pay only for results, so affiliate work suits people who can explain products well and build an audience with trust.

- Promoting products the audience does not need.
- Hidden affiliate links that break disclosure rules.
- Programmes with unclear commission rules.

Skills you need

- Choosing programmes and reading terms.
- Honest product content and reviews.
- Tracking links and attribution.
- Disclosure rules in your country and platform.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Shopify affiliate programme	Partners earn commission on referred Shopify sales (check current terms)	Free to join	Commission-based	www.shopify.com/affiliates
Amazon Associates	Commission on referred purchases (check terms)	Free to join	Commission-based	affiliate-program.amazon.in
Impact	Affiliate network (verify plans)	Trial	Paid plans	impact.com
Google Analytics	Track referral traffic	Free	Paid 360 tier	analytics.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish

Beginner	Read one affiliate programme's terms and list five rules.
Intermediate	Write one honest review with pros and cons.
Advanced	Set up tracking and check one referral click.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Review blog for a niche.
- **Intermediate:** Video review series.
- **Advanced:** Email recommendations with disclosure.

Client-ready portfolio project

An affiliate content plan for a fictional blog: programme choice, one honest review, disclosure text and a tracking check.

Worked example

How it works in practice. A reader clicks your tracked link, buys, and the programme records the sale and pays a commission based on the rule (for example a percentage of the sale, or a fixed amount). The merchant sets the rules; you must follow them and disclose the relationship.

SHOPIFY AND RESALE MODELS

Some platforms let people resell products they do not hold, or run affiliate or reseller programmes for suppliers. Their terms, fees and legal requirements differ and change. Verify the official rules on the platform's own site before you start, and take tax advice on the income.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Affiliate content with disclosure

Business problem: A blogger wants to earn commissions from one shopping programme.

Steps

1. Read the programme's terms and list the commission basis, the cookie window and the banned tactics.
2. Write one review with three honest pros and three honest cons.
3. Add a clear disclosure sentence near the link.
4. Check that the tracked link records one test click.

Expected output: The terms summary, the review, the disclosure and the tracking check.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

The review is honest about the product's weaknesses, which builds trust and protects you from complaints. The disclosure is visible without scrolling. The tracking check confirms the link works before publication.

Common mistakes

- Hiding disclosures.
- Making income claims.
- Promoting unverified products.
- Ignoring the programme's rules on paid ads or brand terms.

Freelancing opportunities

- Affiliate content plans for niche sites.
- Shopify partner-referral strategies (verify terms first).
- Briefs for 'affiliate marketing', 'content writing for affiliates', 'Shopify affiliate'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Shopify affiliate programme (official)
- FTC: disclosures 101 for social media (US guidance, for reference)

Part of **Master Freelancing: Marketing**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full text book. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.